Ceres & District Community Council Meeting

Minutes of Public |Meeting held at Craigrothie Village Hall

14th September 2026

1. Chairs Welcome and Apologies from Cllr Margaret Kennedy & Neil Martin

2.Publicity to highlight roles of Community Council and Community Trust

3. Community Trust Projects and Funding Updates

- Discussion of a possible future duck race linked to the opening of the new bridge at the Glebe and Accessible path.
- Path works are expected to be completed shortly, with gates and fencing also nearing completion.
- Significant community investment was highlighted, including:
    - Burn wall improvements
    - Drainage projects
    - Play Park improvements
    - Glebe works
    - Hall improvements
- It was noted that approximately £800,000 to £900,000 of investment has been brought into the community over recent years.

4& 8 Road & Traffic Matters

Cupar-Ceres Road Surface Issues

Concerns remain regarding road resurfacing work in Ceres:

- Incorrect road cambers causing drainage issues.
- Water reportedly running away from drains rather than towards them.
- Damage to walls and kerbing during works
- Safety concerns regarding large rocks at roadside locations-Meldrums Hotel.
- The issues were first raised in January and remain unresolved.
- A member of the public also highlighted damage done to a house on Anstruther road when pneumatic “pounders” and drills were used.

Proposed Action

- Councillor John Caffrey advised that if no satisfactory response is received from Fife Council, he intends to submit a formal complaint to the Chief Executive after returning from annual leave.

Road Maintenance Concerns

Residents raised:

- Blocked Street drains in Craigrothie
- Faulty flashing speed signs-Ceres
- Delays in repairing potholes-Ceres-Weymsshall Road
- Lack of follow-up on reported issues.

Councillors encouraged residents to:

- Record complaint reference numbers.
- Copy councillors or provide complaint reference details to allow follow-up.

Traffic Issues

Concerns included:

- Increased traffic through Ceres and Craigrothie when the A91 is closed.
- Aggressive driving on local roads used as diversions.
- Parking issues around Walton Park Road bollards.
- Large vehicles and camper vans being directed into unsuitable routes by satellite navigation.
- Potential need to review local signage and parking restrictions.

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5. Elmwood College

Discussion focused on:

- The report by Professor Ian Boyd into Elmwood College.
- Findings suggesting systemic failures.

- Concerns regarding the reduction of rural and agricultural education opportunities.
- Impact on:
    - Local farming businesses.
    - Young people seeking agricultural careers.
    - Students with additional support needs.

Members expressed support for efforts to preserve or restore educational provision in the area.

6. Local Development Plan (2027)

Discussion took place regarding the forthcoming Local Development Plan.

Key points:

- The draft is currently expected to be considered by Cabinet in December.
- Community Council members expressed concern over the potential for development allocations affecting Ceres and Craigrothie.
- Councillors confirmed consultation will be available before adoption.
- Community Council agreed to closely monitor the process.

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7. Telecommunications

Update provided regarding mobile coverage:

- Vodafone has recognised poor mobile coverage in the area.
- Discussions involving Willie Rennie are continuing.
- Potential improvements may be delivered before the 2027 Ceres Games.
- Community Council agreed pressure should continue to be applied for network upgrades.

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9. Police Matters

- Report that a stolen bicycle taken from outside the village shop has been recovered.
- Police have been involved and the matter appears to have been resolved.

10. Resilience and Warm Spaces

- Members noted the importance of promoting local warm spaces and resilience facilities.
- Both this venue (Craigrothie Village Hall)and the Memorial Hall were highlighted as community assets.

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11 AOB

. Hospital Parking Concerns

The Community Council considered concerns raised by other Fife Community Councils regarding hospital parking.

Issues identified:

- Insufficient parking at Victoria Hospital and Queen Margaret Hospital.
- Difficulties for patients attending appointments or A&E.
- General support for raising concerns with NHS and relevant authorities.

Community Hall Fundraising-Memorial Hall Ceres

Update received regarding fundraising for hall improvements:

- A quiz night is being held to raise funds.
- Grant applications are being explored.
- Advice from those involved in successful hall improvement projects for the refurbishment of Craigrothie Village Hall will be sought.

Power Supply Issues

Residents raised concerns regarding:

- Repeated short power interruptions in Chance Inn and surrounding areas.
- Reports of a loud electrical incident/explosion near overhead power infrastructure.
- Potential impact on:

- Livestock
- Home businesses
- IT equipment
- Specialist equipment such as kilns

The issue is to be monitored and followed up with Scottish Power.

Key Actions

Action	**Lead**
Consider formal complaint regarding Cupar-Ceres Road works if no progress made	Cllr John Caffrey
Gather list of unresolved roads, drainage and pothole complaints	Community Council
Monitor publication of 2027 Local Development Plan	Community Council
Continue lobbying for improved mobile coverage	Councillors / Community Council
Follow up power interruption concerns with utility provider	Community Council
Support hall fundraising initiatives	Community Council and community groups